

sound system and electric buttons on the side of the front passenger seat to allow the rear passenger to adjust the seat in front of them while seated at the back. This and other features like the reclining rear seatback, charging ports at the rear along with air-con vents make the Tucson not only a driver's car but also one for the rear passengers—something that is crucial to the Indian market.

Hyundai has stuck to the tried-and-tested 2.0-litre powertrains for India with both the engines being carried forward from the previous generation Tucson. The diesel variant with the 8-speed automatic transmission makes it one of the best powertrains in the country in terms of providing great drivability as well as good efficiency. Its transition to the new-gen model seems to have made it quieter and smoother without compromising on quick acceleration and drivability. Of course, there is also the HTRAC 4WD system on offer with drive modes to help negotiate different types of terrain.

The ride and handling characteristics are also very similar to the previous generation Tucson with the suspension set up on the stiffer side to replicate car-like behaviour on the road with minimal body roll and the ability to glide over bad road surface conditions at higher speeds.

The Tucson offers more or less everything that one can ask for from an SUV of this size with ample space and is full of features that are found in the high-end premium and luxury cars that perhaps cost twice as much. It is value for money and would be scoring over both lower- and higher-priced SUVs on that front. And to top it all, it is an absolute head-turner and would make the buyer feel good about their purchase every time they go for a drive. ■

Hyundai Tucson Signature 4WD
Engine 2.0 diesel
Power 186bhp
Torque 416Nm
Gearbox 8-speed AT
Price Rs 34.5 lakh (ex-showroom)

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